Coaching Stipends: Peer Comparison

Three SD County peers (Helix, San Marcos, and Steele Canyon Charter) pay head varsity football coaches more than GUHSD at every experience tier. GUHSD's stipend cap of 52 positions per school is below the conversion charters' allocations (Helix 73, Steele Canyon 72). Helix is ranked #14 among California high schools for athletes (USA Today HSS / Niche, April 2026); no GUHSD comprehensive site appears in the top 25.

GUHSD STIPEND CAP / SCHOOL

52

For 24+ sports. Football funded at 6 total slots (3V + 1JV + 2F). Positions above 52 are unpaid or booster-funded.

HELIX / STEELE CANYON

73 / 72

Two GUHSD conversion charters in the Grossmont League. **~40% more stipended positions per school** than GUHSD.

SMUSD VS GUHSD (YEAR 5)

+$2,471

Head varsity football, Year 5: SMUSD $8,006 vs. GUHSD $5,535. SMUSD's teacher base salary is 18% lower.

Head Varsity Football — verified 2025–26 schedule

District	Entry Tier	Top Tier	Notes
Helix Charter HS	$6,033 (1–3 yr)	**$9,251** (10+ yr w/cred)	11.5% × Class 3 Step 1 ($80,444). 2026-27 top: $11,664.
San Marcos USD	$6,668 (Yr 1)	**$8,675** (Yr 15+) — Class AA	Higher % rates on a 18% lower base. Year 5 = $8,006.
Steele Canyon Charter	$5,531 (1–3 yr)	**$8,692** (10+ yr)	Same % structure as GUHSD but on Class 3 Step 4 ($79,021).
GUHSD	**$4,843 (1–3 yr)**	**$7,611 (10+ yr w/assts)**	**4 tiers; 7 yrs outside-district credit.**
SDUHSD	$5,123 (1–4 yr)	$7,069 (20+ yr)	5 tiers; no outside credit. 28% less per-ADA than GUHSD.
SDUSD	$7,020 flat	$7,020 flat	Per-unit pricing: 5 units × $1,404. AD on 208-day work year.
Sweetwater UHSD	$6,764 flat	$6,764 flat	Day-one pay; named assistant lines for football, wrestling, swim, track.

Athletic Director compensation — GUHSD is the lowest of the verified peers except Sweetwater

District	AD Compensation	Notes
Steele Canyon Charter	**$13,434** top tier	+116% over GUHSD; 17% × Class 3 Step 4. 1 release period/yr.
Helix Charter	$10,458 → **$13,675**	13%–17% × Class 3 Step 1 + Asst AD ($5,108–$8,326) + job-description supplement.
SDUSD	**$12,636**	3 units × 3 seasons × $1,404 + 208-day work year + Athletic PE class.
SMUSD	**15% salary differential**	On full Certificated Salary Schedule placement; ~$10K+ for Year-5 teacher; no separate stipend.
SDUHSD	$5,395 → $7,354	Class AA (top class); 5 tiers.
GUHSD	**$3,459 → $6,227 (10+ yr)**	**JV/Asst-class tier — below head varsity football. 2 release periods/yr.**
Sweetwater	$4,256 flat	The only verified peer paying less than GUHSD.

PRIMARY SOURCES

GUHSD *Extended Curricular Assignments 2025–26* (Board approved 11/13/2025, 2% increase) + *Coaching Stipends — Sports & Levels*, updated 7/2023. Helix Charter HS *2025–26 HTA Salary Schedule* (Board 10/20/2025) + *2024–25 HCHS Stipend Allotment List*. Steele Canyon Charter HS *Extended Curricular Assignments 2025-2026* (3% increase eff. 7/1/2025). San Marcos USD *2025-26 Extra Duty Stipends* (eff. 7/1/25) + SMEA/SMUSD CBA Section 8(D). SDUSD per-unit coaching stipend schedule. SDUHSD *Extra-Curricular Salary Schedule* (Board 6/11/2025). Sweetwater UHSD *Salary Schedule – Athletics, Appendix C-2* (Board 1/6/2026). Full report:

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